

Propositions

Definition (proposition): A proposition, or statement, is a declarative sentence which is either true or false

For example, "the Sun is white", " $1+2=3$ ", and " $1+2=4$ " are all propositions.

However, " 42 " and " $1+2$ " are not propositions.

Definition (Connectives): Connectives, or logical operators, or truth functions, are defined by means of truth tables. The symbols p and q denote propositions; $\top$ stands for "true" and F stands for "false".

$\wedge$ and $\Rightarrow$ implied by
 $\vee$ or $\Leftrightarrow$ if and only if (iff)
 $\neg$ not
 $\Rightarrow$ implies

Here are some truth table examples:

P	$\neg P$
F	$\top$
$\top$	F

P	q	$P \wedge q$	$P \vee q$	$P \Rightarrow q$
F	F	F	F	$\top$
F	$\top$	F	$\top$	$\top$
$\top$	F	F	$\top$	F
$\top$	$\top$	$\top$	$\top$	$\top$

All logical possibilities in table


If two propositions are logically equivalent, then it will be reflected in the truth table. For instance:

P	q	$P \wedge \neg q$	$\neg(P \Rightarrow q)$
F	F	F	F
F	$\top$	F	F
$\top$	F	$\top$	$\top$
$\top$	$\top$	F	F

Therefore, $(P \wedge \neg q)$ is logically equivalent to $\neg(P \Rightarrow q)$

Definition (tautologies and contradictions): A sentence that is always true is called a tautology, whilst a statement that is always false is called a contradiction.

Here are some useful tautologies:

$P \Rightarrow (P \vee Q)$ is known as addition

$(P \wedge Q) \Rightarrow P$ is known as simplification

$[P \wedge (P \Rightarrow Q)] \Rightarrow Q$ (Modus Ponens)

$(\neg P \Rightarrow C) \Rightarrow P$ and $(P \Rightarrow Q) \Leftrightarrow [(P \wedge \neg Q) \Rightarrow C]$ (Reductio ad Absurdum)

$\neg(P \wedge Q) \Leftrightarrow (\neg P \vee \neg Q)$ (De Morgan's law)

$(P \Rightarrow Q) \Leftrightarrow (\neg Q \Rightarrow \neg P)$ (Contrapositive law)

Sets

A **set** is a collection of objects known as elements. For example, $\{1, 2, 3\}$ is the set of numbers 1, 2, and 3.

Some well known sets are:

N: the set of natural numbers $\{1, 2, 3, \dots\}$

Z: the set of integers $\{\dots, -3, -2, -1, 0, 1, 2, 3, \dots\}$

Q: the set of rational numbers $\{\frac{m}{n} : (m, n \in \mathbb{Z}) \wedge (n \neq 0)\}$

R: the set of real numbers (can be written using decimals)

∅: the empty set

$\in$ simply means in
↙

$\in$ means "in" or "is an element of", so $a \in A$ means a is an element of A .

Definition (universal and existential quantifiers): $\forall$ means "for all" or "for each", whilst $\exists$ means "there exists" or "there is"

To negate a proposition containing quantifiers, flip the quantifier and truth:

$$\neg[(\forall x \in A)(P(x))] \rightarrow (\exists x \in A)(\neg P(x))$$

or

$$(\forall x \in A)(\neg P(x))$$

Definition (subset): Let A and B be sets. A is a subset of B if for all $x \in A, x \in B$. This is denoted as $A \subseteq B$.

Sets can be built from other sets or properties:

$$S = \{x \in A \mid p(x)\}$$

For instance, $\mathbb{Q} = \{\frac{m}{n} : m, n \in \mathbb{Z} \wedge n \neq 0\}$

Definition (Set operations): Let X be a universe of discourse and let A and B be subsets of X .

Then:

- The intersection of A and B is denoted using $A \cap B = \{x \in X : x \in A \wedge x \in B\}$
- The union of A and B is denoted using $A \cup B = \{x \in X : x \in A \vee x \in B\}$
- The relative complement of B in A is denoted with $A - B$ or $A \setminus B = \{x \in X : x \in A \wedge x \notin B\}$

Definition (convection): Let X be an acknowledged universe of discourse, and let A be a subset of X . The relative complement of A in X is denoted A^c , known as the complement of A .

Definition (set equality): Let A and B be sets. The set A and B are equal if $A \subseteq B$ and $B \subseteq A$.